JANANI RANGANATHAN

Architect · Urban Designer · Urban Planner

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PROFILE

Architect and Urban Designer with more than seven years of experience, with a strong foundation in spatial design with expertise in urban policy, GIS-based analysis, and design development. Currently pursuing a Master's in Advanced Urban Planning and Data Analytics at IAAC, Barcelona, with strong interests in climate-responsive urbanism, mobility systems, and data-driven decision-making. Gold Medallist in M. Arch (Urban Design) with some experience in GIS-based analysis, campus master planning, and heritage conservation. Driven by a passion for designing cities that are equitable, resilient, and environmentally responsive.

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

DESIGN & PLANNING

Urban Design · Urban Planning
Architectural Design· Interior Design

POLICY & GOVERNANCE

Urban Policy Analysis · Local Governance
Sustainable Development · Community & Stakeholder Engagement

RESEARCH & ANALYSIS

Qualitative & Quantitative Research
Survey Design & Data Collection
Academic Publishing ·

TECHNICAL TOOLS

Urban Design · GIS & Spatial Analysis · Data Visualization
Software: QGIS · AutoCAD · Rhino · Grasshopper · Photoshop· InDesign · SketchUp · Microsoft Office Suite

EDUCATION

M.Arch – Advanced Urban Planning & Data Analytics *2025 – 2027*
Institute of Advanced Architecture of Catalonia (IAAC)

M.Arch – Urban Design 🏅 **Gold Medallist** *2014 – 2016*
Jadavpur University, Kolkata
Thesis: Redevelopment of Temple Town, Kancheepuram

B.Arch. – Architecture *2008 – 2013*
SRM University, Chennai
Thesis: Cultural Hub in Siliguri, West Bengal

FELLOWSHIP & RESEARCH

Urban Policy & Local Governance Fellow *2024- 2025*
UPLGYF Fellowship | India

- Engaging with urban policy frameworks, local governance structures, and civic reform mechanisms to build expertise in evidence-based urban decision-making.
- Applying cross-disciplinary knowledge of spatial design and policy analysis to real-world governance challenges.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Internship
World Wide Fund for Nature | Delhi *Aug 2026 – Sept 2026*

- Contributed to research on integrated spatial planning and the development of guidance for incorporating ecological, climate and biodiversity considerations into spatial planning.
- Reviewed URDPFI Guidelines, national policies, planning frameworks and institutional mandates relevant to integrated spatial planning in India.
- Conducted secondary research and policy analysis to identify gaps, overlaps and opportunities for integrating biodiversity and environmental considerations into planning processes.

Urban Design, Research Assistant & Assistant Professor
School of Planning and Architecture | Bhopal *Jan 2023 – Jul 2024*

Hindustan University | Chennai *Mar 2021 – May 2022*
Om Dayal Group of Institutions | Kolkata *Jun 2016 – Feb 2021*

- Led the architectural planning and design for Phase 2 of the SPAB Campus Expansion, managing spatial programming, circulation, and design documentation.
- Collaborated with NID Bhopal on the preparation of a strategic movement plan for their campus, integrating pedestrian flow, accessibility, and landscape connectivity.
- Developed a comprehensive Flood Risk Assessment Framework and City Resilience Roadmap as a research proposal, addressing urban vulnerability to climate-induced flooding.
- Completed a freelance commercial interior project, delivering space planning, material specification, and execution oversight for a corporate office.
- Organized industry-collaborated workshops and seminars, bridging academic curriculum with current professional practice and emerging urban trends.

Junior Designer *Sep 2013 – Jul 2014*
Edifice Architects | Mumbai

- Contributed to the design and execution of residential and commercial architectural projects, aligning deliverables with client requirements and building regulations.
- Prepared detailed drawings, specifications, and client presentation packages, improving communication of design intent across project stakeholders.

Internships
- Assisted in the heritage restoration of Writer's Building, Kolkata — one of the city's most significant colonial-era landmarks.
- Worked with Space Matrix (Chennai) and G.A. Architects (Chennai) on projects including National Police Academy (Hyderabad), 5-star hotel interiors, and township residences.

PUBLICATION

1. *"Bengali Adda: A Reason for Existence of Public Spaces in West Bengal"* — Maharashtra Association of Schools of Architecture (MASA)
2. "*Role of Public Participation and Governance in Designing Spaces Under Flyovers: A Study of Commoning and Gender-Inclusive Public Spaces"* - UPLGYF Urban Policy Local Governance Youth Fellowship: An Anthology of Essays| IMPRI.

SELECTED STUDIO PROJECTS@IAAC

Collectively Forward – Trinitat, Barcelona *April 2026*

(As a part of *C40 Reinventing Cities Competition*)

Analysed infrastructure-driven neighbourhood fragmentation in Trinitat Nova/Vella caused by a six-lane highway (Ronda de Dalt) and Avinguda Meridiana.

Urban Mirror *February 2026*

Designed an urban game for Trinitat Nova and Vella that turns everyday commutes and routines into moments of shared public authorship. Selected four micro-locations based on natural pause behaviour to create a participatory experience stitching residents' traces across divided neighbourhoods.

Sand Mining – from Afar *February 2026*

Built a satellite-based detection framework to identify and distinguish legal versus illegal sand mining using Landsat 8/9 multi-temporal imagery. Applied NDVI, BSI, and MNDWI change detection with QGIS Raster Calculator on the Dwarakeshwar River, West Bengal.

Poblenou as Lived Space *February 2026*

Applied Henri Lefebvre's spatial triad (conceived / perceived / lived space) to investigate how a group of international female students construct meaning in Poblenou, Barcelona. Combined a structured survey, group mapping workshop, and geospatial analysis to map emotional landscapes, gendered safety perceptions, and everyday habits — translating lived experience into a collective counter-cartography.

What's Happening to Our Downtowns? *December 2025*

Investigated post-pandemic transformations of central business districts U.S. cities using a mixed-methods approach. Extracted parameters from foundational urban theories (Concentric Zone, Sector, Multiple-Nuclei models) and mapped them Integrated qualitative lenses from Jane Jacobs and Jan Gehl to map density, open space, and pedestrian infrastructure.

Inclusive Wayfinding *October 2025*

Designed an inclusive, child-centred wayfinding system connecting schools to Parc dels Pins in Santa Coloma de Gramenet, an area with significant cultural diversity. Used participatory co-design sessions with children, educators, and municipal staff, and a symbol-based universal signage language to create safe, legible paths through a steeply topographic neighbourhood.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

COURSES & CERTIFICATIONS

- GIS & Remote Sensing for Urban Planning (National Level, Council of Architecture — Level 1 & 2)
- Energy Conservation Building Code – ECBC (Council of Architecture & Bureau of Energy Efficiency)
- Green Spaces — 5-day online course (U-Green)
- Questionnaire Design & Data Collection (Hindustan University)
- The Living Past — Heritage Conservation Workshop (Reva University, 3-day)

SEMINARS & FORUMS

- Awas Par Samvaad: Technology & Innovation — Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
- Environment-Friendly Homes: Past, Present & Future (Assocham India)
- Spatiotemporal Continuum of Traditional Knowledge in Architecture (COA-TRC Bhopal)
- UGC Refresher Course — Built Environment & Sustainable Technologies (Jadavpur University)